GCC Workplace Benchmark 2026

Space, cost, service and experience metrics from 38 Global Capability Centres in India

This benchmark summarises the responses of 38 Global Capability Centres (GCCs) in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai and the NCR, covering about 62,000 seats. Figures are medians unless stated; ranges show the inter-quartile spread. Participation was anonymous and data was validated against each centre's lease and service contracts.

1. Headline numbers

Metric	Median	Inter-quartile range
Area per seat (sq ft)	78	65 to 92
Peak weekday occupancy	58%	46% to 71%
Seat-to-headcount ratio	0.72	0.60 to 0.85
Integrated FM cost per sq ft per month (Rs)	34	27 to 43
Cost per occupied seat per month (Rs)	4,380	3,500 to 5,600
Cafeteria subsidy per meal (Rs)	46	30 to 62
Helpdesk first-time-fix rate	81%	74% to 88%

2. What high performers do differently

- Measure occupancy by badge, Wi-Fi and desk sensors together and plan against the 80th percentile day, not the average
- Run a single helpdesk with one SLA scorecard across hard and soft services
- Use a rolling 12-month service calendar so planned maintenance avoids peak anchor days
- Keep a small, empowered experience team instead of outsourcing every employee-facing decision
- Report cost per occupied seat, not only cost per square foot

3. Space strategy

Activity-based layouts now account for 62% of new fit-outs. Centres that moved to a 0.7 seat ratio saved a median of 9% on rent and 6% on operating cost but invested an average of Rs 1,800 per seat in booking tools, lockers and collaboration upgrades. The payback was 19 months. The most common regret was under-investing in meeting rooms: booking conflicts were the top experience complaint in 71% of centres.

4. Experience and wellbeing

- Average monthly employee satisfaction with the workplace: 3.9 out of 5
- Top complaints: meeting-room availability, noise, temperature, parking, lift waiting times
- Centres with a daily air-quality display recorded 11% fewer comfort tickets
- Quiet zones and phone booths were rated more valuable than new breakout furniture

5. Method note

Seat counts were verified from layouts; costs include rent-free operating costs only; totals exclude capex and amortised fit-out. The sample is skewed towards centres of 800 to 5,000 seats. Treat the ranges as a guide for planning conversations, not as a target.